PARISHRAM 2.0

CLASS 12TH 2026

Flamingo-**Lost Spring** (Part-02)

ENGLISH LECTURE 04

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TOPICS TO BE COVERED

1 Lost Spring (Part-02)

I want to drive a car

Mukesh → different from Sahib

Dared to Dream

Sahib-e-Alam → Dhaka

Motor Mechanic

Firozabad → UP (Backward town)

Profession → Bangle making


WELCOME TO OUR TEAM
English
Rocket
Raccoon
YOU ARE GOING TO LOVE
IT HERE!

Topic : Lost Spring

"I want to drive a car"

Mukesh insists on being his own master. "I will be a motor mechanic," he announces. "Do you know anything about cars?" I ask.

"I will learn to drive a car," he answers, looking straight into my eyes. His dream looms like a mirage amidst the dust of streets that fill his town Firozabad, famous for its bangles.

Every other family in Firozabad is engaged in making bangles.





Topic : Lost Spring

It is the centre of India's glass-blowing industry where families have spent generations working around furnaces, welding glass, making bangles for all the women in the land it seems.

Mukesh's family is among them. None of them know that it is illegal for children like him to work in the glass furnaces with high temperatures, in dingy cells without air and light; that the law, if enforced, could get him and all those 20,000 children out of the hot furnaces where they slog their daylight hours, often losing the brightness of their eyes.





Topic : Lost Spring





Topic : Lost Spring

Mukesh's eyes beam as he volunteers to take me home, which he proudly says is being rebuilt. We walk down stinking lanes choked with garbage, past homes that remain hovels with crumbling walls, wobbly doors, no windows, crowded with families of humans and animals coexisting in a primeval state.

He stops at the door of one such house, bangs a wobbly iron door with his foot, and pushes it open. We enter a half-built shack.





Topic : Lost Spring

In one part of it, thatched with dead grass, is a firewood stove over which sits a large vessel of sizzling spinach leaves. On the ground, in large aluminum platters, are more chopped vegetables. A frail young woman is cooking the evening meal for the whole family. Through eyes filled with smoke she smiles. She is the wife of Mukesh's elder brother. Not much older in years, she has begun to command respect as the bahu, the daughter-in-law of the house, already in charge of three men – her husband, Mukesh and their father.



poor
illiterate
orthodox

Topic : Lost Spring

When the older man enters, she gently withdraws behind the broken wall and brings her veil closer to her face. As custom demands, daughters-in-law must veil their faces before male elders.

In this case the elder is an impoverished bangle maker. Despite long years of hard labour, first as a tailor then a bangle maker, he has failed to renovate a house, send his two sons to school.



17:25

Topic : Lost Spring

useless skill - that has no future

All he has managed to do is teach them what he knows — the art of making bangles. "It is his Karam, his destiny," says Mukesh's grandmother, who has watched her own husband go blind with the dust from polishing the glass of bangles. "Can a god given lineage ever be broken?" she implies. Born in the caste of bangle makers, they have seen nothing but bangles — in the house, in the yard, in every other house, every other yard, every street in Firozabad.

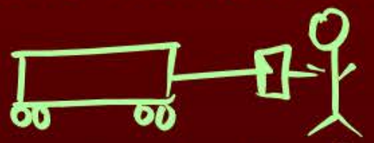
परंपरा



She thinks that god has made them poor. It cannot be changed.

Topic : Lost Spring

Spirals of bangles — sunny gold, paddy green, royal blue, pink, purple, every colour born out of the seven colours of the rainbow — lie in mounds in unkempt yards, are piled on four-wheeled handcarts, pushed by young men along the narrow lanes of the shanty town.



And in dark hutments, next to lines of flames of flickering oil lamps, sit boys and girls with their fathers and mothers, welding pieces of coloured glass into circles of bangles.





Topic : Lost Spring

long hours

Their eyes are more adjusted to the dark than to the light outside. That is why they often end up losing their eyesight before they become adults.

another girl.

Savita, a young girl in a drab pink dress, sits alongside an elderly woman, soldering pieces of glass.

joining

parts

As her hands move mechanically like the tongs of a machine, I wonder if she knows the sanctity of the bangles she helps make.

importance

It symbolises an Indian woman's suhaag, auspiciousness in marriage.

Married

goodness

सुहाग-विवाह.



Topic : Lost Spring

realise

It will dawn on her suddenly one day when her head is draped with a red veil, her hands dyed red with henna, and red bangles rolled onto her wrists. She will then become a bride. Like the old woman beside her who became one many years ago. She still has bangles on her wrist, but no light in her eyes. – blind.



"Ek waqt ser bhar khana bhi nahin khaya," she says, in a voice drained of joy. She has not enjoyed even one full meal in her entire lifetime — that's what she has reaped! – got.

full meals

Topic : Lost Spring



Her husband, an old man with a flowing beard, says, "I know nothing except bangles. long
All I have done is make a house for the family to live in."

Hearing him, one wonders if he has achieved what many have failed in their lifetime. He has a roof over his head! thinking (make thier own house

The cry of not having money to do anything except carry on the business of making bangles, not even enough to eat, rings in every home. → More expenses than income

Topic : Lost Spring

The young men echo the lament of their elders. Little has moved with time, it seems, in Firozabad. Years of mind-numbing toil have killed all initiative and the ability to dream. "Why not organise yourselves into a cooperative?"

I ask a group of young men who have fallen into the vicious circle of middlemen who trapped their fathers and forefathers. "Even if we get organised, we are the ones who will be hauled up by the police, beaten and dragged to jail for doing something illegal," they say.



Bangle makers → Middlemen

worst sufferers

final Market

Topic : Lost Spring



There is no leader among them, no one who could help them see things differently.

Their fathers are as tired as they are. They talk endlessly in a spiral that moves from poverty to apathy to greed and to injustice.

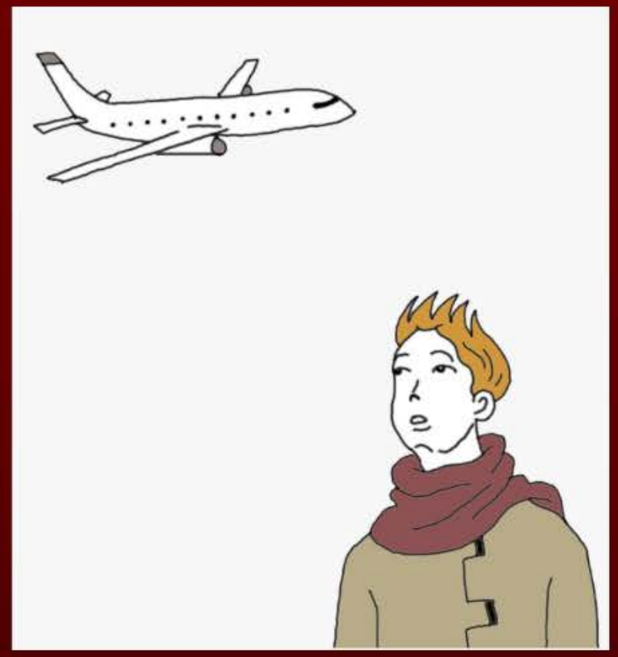
Listening to them, I see two distinct worlds — one of the family, caught in a web of poverty, burdened by the stigma of caste in which they are born; the other a vicious circle of the Sahukars, the middlemen, the policemen, the keepers of law, the bureaucrats and the politicians.

Topic : Lost Spring

Together they have imposed the baggage on the child that he cannot put down. Before he is aware, he accepts it as naturally as his father. To do anything else would mean to dare. And daring is not part of his growing up. When I sense a flash of it in Mukesh I am cheered. "I want to be a motor mechanic,' he repeats. He will go to a garage and learn. But the garage is a long way from his home. "I will walk," he insists. "Do you also dream of flying a plane?" He is suddenly silent. "No," he says, staring at the ground.

burden

to agaunst the system



clear goals/ambitions

goal oriented

hesitant

Topic : Lost Spring

In his small murmur there is an embarrassment that has not yet turned into regret.

He is content to dream of cars that he sees hurtling down the streets of his town.

Few airplanes fly over Firozabad.

satisfied

not seen much
So did not think of becoming a pilot

more

QUESTION

#Q. What forces the children to live a life of exploitation?

1. Greed
2. Extreme Poverty
3. Peers
4. Parents



QUESTION

#Q. According to the author what was garbage for the parents?

1. Means of entertainment
2. Means of joy
3. Means of sorrow
4. Means of survival



QUESTION

#Q. According to the author what was garbage for the children ?

1. Means of entertainment
2. Means of timepass
3. Means of playing
4. A wonder



QUESTION

#Q. Who was Saheb?

1. A shopkeeper
2. A servant
3. A ragpicker
4. All



QUESTION

#Q. What was Saheb looking for?

1. Eggs
2. Gold
3. Coins
4. Toys



QUESTION

#Q. Is Saheb happy working at the tea stall?

1. Yes
2. Yes, he earns money
3. No earning
4. No, earning but no freedom



QUESTION

#Q. Why did Saheb -e- Alam not go to school?

1. Not interested
2. Had no money to pay fees
3. Wanted to go for movie
4. Wanted to earn money



QUESTION

#Q. What is the meaning of Saheb -e- Alam?

1. Owner
2. Rich man
3. Poor man
4. Lord of the Universe



QUESTION

#Q. Where was Saheb employed?

1. At a tea stall in Seemapuri
2. At a saree shop
3. At a jewellery shop
4. At a sweet shop



QUESTION

#Q. Why is the author calling garbage as ‘gold’ in the story?

1. Because of jewels in it
2. Because of gems in it
3. Because of gold in it
4. Because of its encashment value



QUESTION

#Q. What do the boys appear like to the author in the story?

1. Morning crows
2. Evening crows
3. Morning birds
4. Evening Birds



QUESTION

#Q. Did Mukesh's parents know that it is illegal for children to work in bangle making?

1. No
2. Yes
3. Not mentioned
4. None of these.

illiteracy

(A)



QUESTION

#Q. What are the biggest dangers of working in a glass furnace?

1. Addiction of money at young age
2. There is a fear of losing eye brightness in early age
3. Accompaniment is bad
4. Drugs addiction

high temp, small spaces, poor ventillation

low light

② 

QUESTION

#Q. What is a shack?

1. Tarpaulin
2. Hut
3. Broken house
4. None of the above



QUESTION

#Q. What was Mukesh's father source of livelihood before bangle making?

1. Tailoring
2. Brokerage
3. Farming
4. Car mechanic



QUESTION

#Q. Why Mukesh's father failed to build a pucca house despite being a hard worker?

1. His expenses were more than income
2. He had a big family to feed
3. He had lot of liabilities
4. He had put all the money in the education and upbringing of the children



QUESTION

#Q. Which of the following is NOT true about the slum in Seemapuri?

1. Structures made of mud
2. No sewage, drainage, running water
3. Roofs of tin and tarpaulin
4. No mobile toilets



QUESTION

#Q. Which season was it when the author saw Saheb standing in front of the tennis court?

1. Summer
2. Rainy
3. Winter
4. Not mentioned in the story



QUESTION

#Q. Which of the following is NOT true about Mukesh's house?

1. Half-built shack ✓
2. Glass-enamored (covered) windows
3. Wobbly iron door ✓
4. Firewood stove with thatched with dead grass

(2)



QUESTION

#Q. Mukesh's grandfather became _____ with the dust from polishing glass bangles.

1. Asthmatic
2. Blind
3. Insomniac
4. Deaf



QUESTION

#Q. The daughter-in-law _____ her face in from of the elders.

1. Washed
2. Uncovered
3. Veiled
4. Touched



QUESTION

#Q. How does the author focus on the 'perpetual state of poverty' of the children not wearing footwear?

Ans. The author notices that most of the young children engaged in rag picking are not wearing footwear. Some of them do not have chappals. Others want to wear shoes. Some say it is tradition to stay barefoot. To the author it seems lack of money. Poverty forces them to walk without footwear.

QUESTION

#Q. What makes the city of Firozabad famous?

Ans. The city of Firozabad is famous for its bangles. Every other family in Firozabad is engaged in making bangles. It is the centre of India's glass-blowing industry. Families have spent generations working around furnaces, welding glass, making bangles for the women in the land.

QUESTION

#Q. Mention the hazards of working in the glass bangles industry? ★ Imp.

Ans. Boys and girls with their fathers and mothers sit in dark hutments, next to lines of flames of flickering oil lamps. They weld pieces of coloured glass into circles of bangles. Their eyes are more adjusted to the dark than to the light outside. They often end up losing eyesight before they become adults. Even the dust from polishing the glass of bangles is injurious to eyes. Many workers have become blind. The furnaces have very high temperature and therefore very dangerous.

Small Spaces, dungy cells, poorly lit / No ventillation
No protective gear

QUESTION

#Q. How is Mukesh's attitude to his situation different from that of his family?

Ans. Mukesh's grandmother thinks that the god given lineage can never be broken. Her son and grandsons are born in the caste of bangle makers. They have seen nothing but bangles.

Mukesh's father has taught them what he knows—the art of making bangles. But Mukesh wants to be a motor mechanic. He will go to a garage and learn, though the garage is far away from his home.

Shows his willingness
determination
ambition
goal orient
Daring

QUESTION

#Q. What could be some of the reasons for the migration of people from villages to cities?

Ans. People migrate from villages to cities in search of livelihood. Their fields fail to provide them means of survival. Cities provide employment, jobs or other means of getting food. The problem in case of the poor is to feed the hungry members. Survival is of primary concern.

QUESTION

#Q. Would you agree that promises made to the poor children are rarely kept? Why do you think this happens in the incidents narrated in the text?

Ans. The promises made to the poor are rarely kept. The author asks Saheb half-joking, whether he will come to her school if she starts one. Saheb agrees to do so. A few days later he asks if the school is ready. The writer feels embarrassed at having made a promise that was not meant. Promises like hers abound in every comer of their bleak world.

QUESTION

#Q. What forces conspire to keep the workers in bangle industry of Firozabad in poverty?

Ans. Certain forces conspire to keep the workers in bangle industry of Firozabad in poverty. These include the moneylenders, the middlemen, the policemen, the keepers of law, the bureaucrats and the politicians. Together they impose a heavy burden on the child.

QUESTION

#Q. How was Mukesh different from other bangle makers?

Ans. Mukesh was different from other bangle makers because he wanted to be his own master. When other bangle manufacturers did not even dare to dream and had accepted their fate, Mukesh had an ambition of becoming a mechanic.

QUESTION

#Q. The youngsters echo the lament of their elders who have been doing the mind-numbing toil of bangle-making since long. This is the reason that the writer says that little has moved with time, it seems, in Firozabad.

Ans. The young people share the sorrow of their elders who have been engaged in the mind-numbing labour of producing bangles for a long time. Because of this, the author claims that hardly much seems to have changed over time in Firozabad.

QUESTION

#Q. Why does Anees Jung say that the bangle makers are caught in a vicious web?

Ans. The bangle makers in Firozabad are exploited at the hands of the Sahukars, middlemen, policemen, law makers, bureaucrats and politicians. They toil day and night, but are not paid appropriate wages and are steeped in poverty. They cannot form cooperatives for their betterment. Moreover, their children are also compelled to join the same trade at an early age and cannot dare to take up any other profession.

QUESTION

#Q. Which industry was a boon and also bane for the people of Firozabad? How?

Ans. The glass-bangles making industry was a boon and also bane for the people of Firozabad. Although the industry has provided them with a means of support, the dangerous working conditions in the hot furnaces have a negative impact on their physical well-being.

QUESTION

#Q. Why do you think Mukesh is content to dream of cars and doesn't dream of flying a plane?

Ans. Mukesh was drawn towards being a motor mechanic and not a pilot because he had seen a lot of cars going around his place but had hardly seen any plane flying past and hence, he made a more realistic or practical decision to be a mechanic instead of a pilot.

QUESTION

#Q. How do you think the author's life might have been impacted after her interactions with the children and their families mentioned in 'Lost Spring'?

Ans. In the chapter 'Lost Spring,' the author 'Anees Jung' discusses the bleak world in which people in positions of power make promises but never try to keep them. We learned from her interactions with Saheb and Mukesh that the author cares about the lower class and oppressed people. She believes that child labour should be prohibited in our country so that children who want to study can do so.

QUESTION

#Q. What do we come to know about the author of Lost Spring, Anees Jung, through her interactions with Saheb and Mukesh?

Ans. In the chapter 'Lost Spring,' the author 'Anees Jung' discusses the bleak world in which people in positions of power make promises but never try to keep them. We learned from her interactions with Saheb and Mukesh that the author cares about the lower class and oppressed people.

QUESTION

#Q. What does the description of Mukesh's family in Lost Spring reveal about gender roles?

Ans. Mukesh's family in Lost Spring reveals patriarchy and inequality in the treatment of men and women. Women in the Mukesh family are still assigned to stereotypical gender roles, such as doing household chores and caregiving, whereas men are assigned to earning work.

QUESTION

#Q. How, in your opinion, can Mukesh realise his dream?

Ans. Mukesh is the son of a poor bangle-maker of Firozabad. Most of the young men of Firozabad have no initiative or ability to dream, but Mukesh is an exception. He has the capacity to take courage and break from the traditional family occupation. He has strong will power also. He does not want to be a pawn in the hands of the middlemen or moneylenders. He insists on being his own master by becoming a motor mechanic. He can realise his dream by joining a garage and learn the job of repairing cars and driving them. He will have to overcome many hurdles before he succeeds. Then comes transport problem. Money is the first one. He will have to earn some money himself. The garage is a long way from his home. He will have to cover it twice everyday anyhow—by walking on foot. Patience, hard work, firm will and the determination to learn will help him realise his dream.

QUESTION

#Q. Mention the hazards of working in the glass bangles industry.

Ans. The glass bangles industry has many health hazards. It usually employs small children. It is illegal to employ very young children in hazardous industries, but certain forces like ! middlemen, moneylenders, police and politicians combine to entrap the poor workers. Let us first consider the places where bangle makers work. It is a cottage industry. They work in the glass furnaces with high temperatures. The dingy cells are without air and light. Boys and girls work hard during day next to lines of flames of flickering oil lamps.

They weld pieces of coloured glass into circles of bangles. Their eyes are more adjusted to the dark than to the light outside. That is why, they often end up losing their eyesight before they become adults. Glass blowing, welding and soldering pieces of glass are all health hazards.

ANSWER

Even the dust from polishing the glass of bangles adversely affects the eyes and even adults go blind. Thus, the surroundings, prevailing conditions and the type of job involved-all prove risky to the health of the workers.

QUESTION

#Q. Why should child labour be eliminated and how?

Ans. Child labour should be eliminated because the children employed at tender age as I domestic servants, dish-washers at road-side dhabas and in hazardous industries making glass bangles, biris, crackers etc. lose the charm of the spring of their life. Their childhood is stolen. Burdened by the responsibility of work, they become adults too soon. Most of them are undernourished, ill-fed, uneducated, and poor. They have a stunted growth.

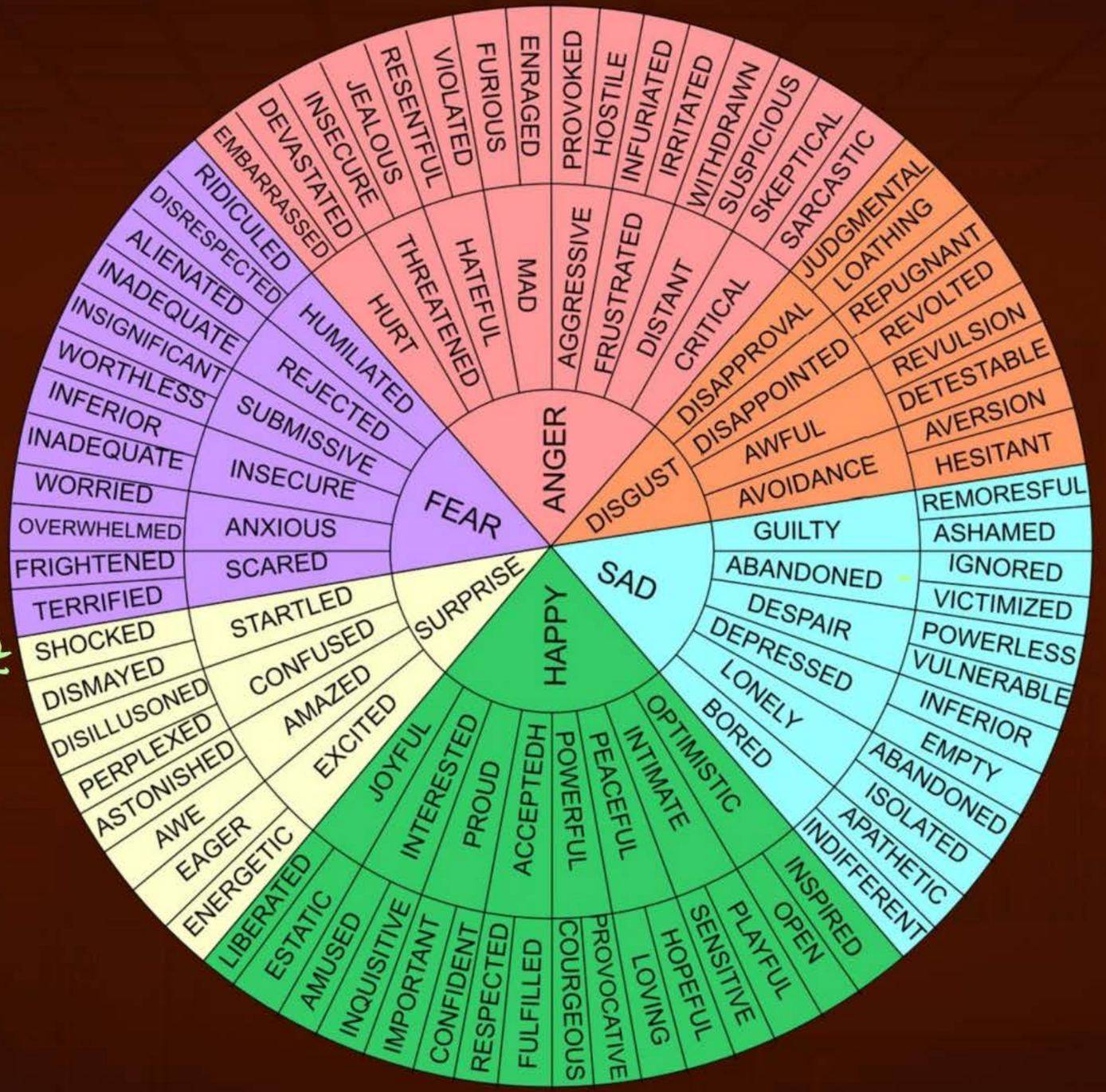
Child labour can be eliminated only through concerted efforts on the part of government agencies, NGOs (Non-Government Organisations), co-operative societies and political leaders. Mere passing of law will not help. Laws should be enacted faithfully. The children thrown out of work should be rehabilitated and given proper food, clothes, education and pocket money. Their feelings, thoughts and emotions should be respected. Let them enjoy sunshine and fresh air.


Each day is a fresh start
Remember, even small steps lead to big changes over time. Stay focused, believe in yourself, and keep going, no matter the obstacles.

QOTD


BYE, BYE.

"Abandoned dreams still whisper hope"



Abandoned
↓
to leave alone

THANK YOU